

Topic 14: Ethics, Attribution, and Sustainable AI Writing Practice

14.1 Disclosure and Transparency

- A growing number of publications, academic institutions, and platforms now require disclosure of AI use
- Best practice: be transparent with your audience and editors about AI assistance in content creation
- Academic integrity: most universities now have explicit policies on AI use in assessed work -- check your institution's policy
- Journalism: major outlets (AP, Reuters, New York Times) have published AI editorial policies; the field is still evolving
- Template: 'This article was drafted with AI assistance and reviewed, edited, and fact-checked by [name]'

14.2 Copyright and Ownership

- AI-generated content copyright is unsettled law in most jurisdictions -- the landscape is rapidly evolving
- US Copyright Office (2024 guidance): purely AI-generated content is generally not copyrightable; human-edited content may be
- Training data lawsuits: ongoing cases are testing whether training AI on copyrighted text constitutes infringement
- Safest commercial use: Adobe Firefly (images) and Getty AI are trained on licensed content
- EU AI Act: requires AI-generated content to be labelled and mandates transparency about training data for high-risk systems

14.3 Accuracy, Misinformation, and Responsibility

- AI confidently produces incorrect information -- publishing without verification spreads misinformation
- Health, legal, and financial content: errors can cause direct harm; apply stricter verification standards
- The human who publishes AI-assisted content is responsible for its accuracy -- not the AI tool
- Apply your normal editorial fact-checking standards to AI-assisted content; do not lower the bar because AI produced a draft
- Bias amplification: AI can perpetuate stereotypes from training data -- review for fairness in sensitive topics

14.4 Building a Sustainable AI Writing Workflow

- Map your content process: ideation -> research -> outline -> draft -> edit -> review -> publish -> distribute
- AI adds most value at: research synthesis, outline generation, first draft, and format variations
- Humans are essential at: strategy, original insight, fact verification, final editing, and approval
- Quality gate: publish nothing without human review -- make this a non-negotiable rule in your process

Sustainable AI content workflow:

1. Strategy (Human): topic, audience, keyword, goal, angle
2. Research (AI + Human): Perplexity for sources, Human validates facts
3. Outline (AI draft -> Human approves)
4. Draft (AI expands outline section by section)
5. Edit (Human deep-edits for voice, accuracy, and insight)
6. SEO (AI: meta description, title tags, FAQ schema)
7. Review (Human: second pass; legal/compliance if needed)
8. Publish and Distribute (AI scheduling tools)